The Holiday Screen Deal

Two weeks off school, one deal made together.
Agreed on day one, so nobody argues on day six.



Our holiday deal | My daily core | The jobs board | Two week grid

Ages 5 to 12

Written for the Christmas holidays, and it works for any school holiday: Easter, half term or the summer, two weeks at a time.

FOR THE GROWN UP · READ THIS FIRST

Ten minutes on day one

School holidays take away the shape of the day, and screens rush in to fill the gap. By the third morning you are bargaining over breakfast. This planner puts a shape back, and you agree it once, together, at the kitchen table, before anybody is cross. Then the deal does the arguing, and you get to be on the same side as your child.

1 · THE CORE

A small amount of screen time that is theirs every day, no stars needed. It keeps the screen from becoming the prize. It does not carry over to tomorrow.

2 · EARNED TIME

Jobs earn stars. One star is five minutes, on any screen in the house. A weekly cap keeps the total sensible, and the count starts fresh each Monday.

3 · PROTECTED

Meals, the hour before bed, family days. No number of stars can buy these. A screen wanted then becomes an ask, never a sneaky start.

THE TEN MINUTE SETUP

1. Print the deal, the jobs board and both weeks. Read the deal out loud together.
2. Fill in the core and your star rate. Five minutes a star is where the app starts.
3. Choose the jobs together. Let your child suggest at least two of them.
4. Agree the protected times and the weekly cap, then both sign.
5. Stick the deal and week one on the fridge. Two minutes each evening fills in the day.

WHERE TO START THE NUMBERS

In the holidays the Guided Childhood app starts from the age guidance, loosened a little: about **70 minutes a day at 5 to 7**, **90 at 8 to 10** and **110 at 11 to 12**. A week of core plus the cap is the most screen time the week can hold, so set them to land near that. Say your child is 8: a core of 30 minutes and a cap of 84 stars comes to 90 minutes a day, if every star is earned. Your family, your numbers.

HOW AN ASK WORKS

A film on Christmas Eve, a call with cousins at teatime. Asks are allowed. You answer every one with a yes, or with a not now and what comes next: "after lunch", "tomorrow morning", "once the walk is done". Your child always knows the next step.

EACH EVENING, TWO MINUTES

Colour the core dots on the week grid, write the stars earned and the minutes used, and let your child draw the day's face. That small habit is the whole planner. On Monday the star count starts fresh.

Stars count when a grown up says yes to the job. Earned stars are never taken back, so consequences live somewhere else. If the deal is not working by day seven, change one thing together. A deal you both still believe in beats a perfect one that nobody keeps.

DAY ONE · READ IT OUT LOUD, THEN BOTH SIGN

Our holiday deal

The _____ family

These holidays run from _____ to _____

1 My core screen time

_____ minutes a day are mine.

No stars needed. Whatever else happens, this is mine. It does not carry over to tomorrow.

2 Our star rate

1 star = _____ minutes.

Five is where most families start. Stars work on any screen: TV, tablet, console, phone, computer.

3 The weekly cap

Up to _____ stars a week,

that is _____ minutes.

When the cap is reached, the jar is full until Monday, when it starts fresh.

4 Our protected times

No stars can buy these. Tick ours.

- ☐ **Mealtimes**
- ☐ **Screens rest from _____**
- ☐ **Family days: _____**
- ☐ _____

5 How an ask works

MY HALF

If I want a screen in a protected time, I ask. I do not just start.

OUR HALF

We always answer. A yes, or a not now and what comes next.

Our not now words _____

Like "after lunch", "tomorrow morning" or "once the walk is done".

_____ _____ _____

SIGNED BY ME | SIGNED BY MY GROWN UP | DATE

We check this deal again on day seven, and change one thing together if we need to.

PRINT ONE PER DAY, OR LAMINATE AND USE A DRY WIPE PEN

My daily core

Day _____ **Date** _____

Five things make a good holiday day. Tick them in any order. My screen time is one of them, and it is mine.



Something outdoors

What I did _____

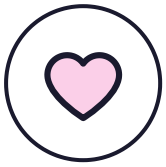
☐



Something I made

What I made _____

☐



Something for someone else

Who and what _____

☐



Reading

What I read _____

☐



My screen time

My core _____ min + earned _____ min

☐

The best bit of today was _____

CHOOSE THESE TOGETHER ON DAY ONE

The jobs board

Each job earns stars. One star is five minutes of screen time, or the rate on your deal. Done a job? Tell your grown up. The stars count when they say yes.

Jobs that earn stars	Stars	Times done
Help cook a meal	★★ 2	
Hoover a room	★★ 2	
Clear and wipe the table after dinner	★ 1	
Sort the recycling	★ 1	
Wash the car or the bikes	★★★ 3	
Write a thank you note	★ 1	
Sort toys or clothes to give away	★★★ 3	
Help in the garden or walk the dog	★★ 2	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	



Family jobs: everyone does them, nobody is paid

These earn no stars, because they are part of living here. The grown ups do them too.

- ☐ Clear my own plate
- ☐ Help when visitors come
- ☐ Put my things away
- ☐ _____

TWO MINUTES EACH EVENING, TOGETHER

Week one

OUR CAP THIS WEEK

_____ stars

Colour a dot for each part of the daily core. Write the stars earned and the minutes used. Keep a running total of stars so you can see the cap coming. Then draw today's face.

Day	Daily core	Stars earned	Stars so far	Minutes used	Draw my face
Day 1 DATE _____					
Day 2 DATE _____					
Day 3 DATE _____					
Day 4 DATE _____					
Day 5 DATE _____					
Day 6 DATE _____					
Day 7 DATE _____					

STARS THIS WEEK

_____

MINUTES THIS WEEK

_____

BEST BIT OF WEEK ONE

_____

THE JAR STARTS FRESH THIS WEEK

Week two

OUR CAP THIS WEEK

_____ stars

Day seven check: is the deal working? If something keeps causing a row, change one thing together and write it here.

Day	Daily core	Stars earned	Stars so far	Minutes used	Draw my face
Day 8 DATE _____					
Day 9 DATE _____					
Day 10 DATE _____					
Day 11 DATE _____					
Day 12 DATE _____					
Day 13 DATE _____					
Day 14 DATE _____					

STARS THIS WEEK

_____

MINUTES THIS WEEK

_____

BEST BIT OF WEEK TWO

_____

THE LAST EVENING OF THE HOLIDAYS

The look back

Sit down together with both weeks in front of you. No marks out of ten. You are looking for what to keep.

WHAT WORKED

WHAT WAS HARD

OUR FAVOURITE THING AWAY FROM A SCREEN

WHAT WE KEEP FOR TERM TIME

School hours become protected time. The rest of the deal can come with you.

Core on school days _____ **minutes** **At weekends** _____ **minutes**

Screens rest from _____ **on school nights** **1 star =** _____ **minutes**

The jobs we keep _____

SOMETHING I AM PROUD OF

FROM ME

SOMETHING I NOTICED ABOUT YOU

FROM MY GROWN UP

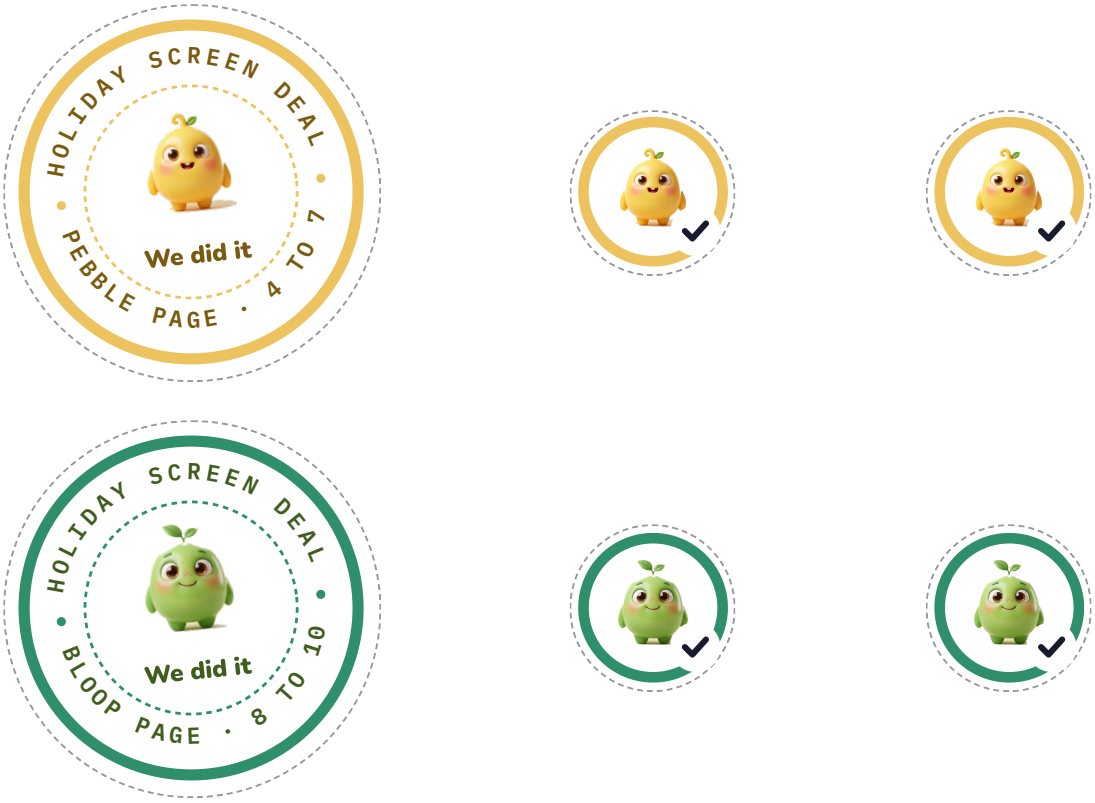
Keep this page. Next holiday, start the new deal from here.

Our next holiday starts _____

THE GUIDED CHILDHOOD PASSPORT

Your Passport stickers

The Holiday Screen Deal belongs on the Pebble page (ages 4 to 7) or the Bloop page (ages 8 to 10), under the doing, in the Guided Childhood Passport. When your family has used the deal, cut out the sticker and stick it on that page. The big one fits the stage page and the small one fits the fold out passport.



PRINT THIS PAGE ON STICKER PAPER, OR ON PLAIN PAPER WITH A GLUE STICK

No Passport yet? Look for the Guided Childhood Passport in the same Etsy shop: five stage pages for ages 4 to 16, each one stamped when the talk, the doing and the check are done.



A FREE GIFT FOR YOUR FAMILY

As a thank you, the full Guided Childhood Starter Pack is yours free: the star chart, the jobs that earn the stars, and a whole booklet of things to do away from a screen. Pop your email in at the address below and it is yours.

guidedchildhood.com/etsy-bonus

Made by Justin at Guided Childhood, a dad who got tired of the screen time fight. If this deal earned its place on your fridge these holidays, a kind review on Etsy helps another family find it.